

SanDisk Corp. (SNDK): Investor Day highlights strong financial targets and capital returns, with upside optionality in HBF technology - Buy

Key stock takeaways: We expect the stock to hold its gains (up 15%) following an Investor Day that highlighted better-than-expected financial targets, strong capital returns, and upside optionality on SanDisk's technology roadmap. First, we believe SanDisk's long-term financial guidance (revenue growth of mid-to-high teens, gross margin of 80%, and operating margin of 75% in FY28-30) was well above investor expectations. Second, management plans to return 100% of excess free cash flow to shareholders, well ahead of peer announcements to date. Third, SanDisk outlined a compelling technology roadmap for its next-generation HBF (high bandwidth flash) technology, which promises to increase AI inference performance while reducing overall system cost tied to HBM (DRAM). Although we acknowledge that long-term customer agreements (NBMs) could help mute industry cyclicality, we think this concept still needs to be proven – and it will take time to be fully reflected in the stock's multiple. In the meantime, we reiterate our Buy rating as believe SanDisk will benefit from limited near-term supply additions in the NAND market – and expect the company's product portfolio and mix to continue to improve.

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Key takeaways include:

- **Long-term financial model and LTA details.** For FY28-30, SanDisk guided to revenue growth in the mid-to-high teens, gross margin of 80%, and operating margin of 75% – with ~50% adjusted free cash flow margin and capital intensity in the mid-single digits. Management emphasized the company's business model shift to a longer-duration framework anchored by its NBMs (long-term customer agreements) which provide better visibility (weighted average duration of four years), more stable pricing (typically fixed pricing in the near term with floor/ceiling price bands in the outer years), and attractive economics (80% gross margin, even at floor pricing). The company highlighted ~\$94bn of TCV (including RPO of \$91bn) at contracted floor prices and ~\$16.5 billion of financial guarantees across eight customers (which it confirmed includes three US hyperscalers). SanDisk reiterated that roughly 50%/67% of its FY27/28 planned volume is covered by NBMs, and that these agreements underpin confidence in its financial targets.
- **Strong capital return policy of 100% excess cash flow, centered on share repurchases.** The company outlined its three primary capital allocation priorities, including: (1) re-invest in the business to maintain its technology edge; (2) maintain a robust balance sheet (no debt and a healthy cash position) to

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improve its credit rating; (3) return 100% of excess cash (free cash flow less business re-investment) to shareholders, adding that it continues to prefer share repurchases as its preferred vehicle. Management added that SanDisk's board previously authorized a \$6 bn buyback (of which ~\$4.5 bn has already been executed), and has since authorized an additional \$14 bn, resulting in ~\$15.5 bn of remaining repurchase capacity.

- **Efficient manufacturing at low capital intensity.** SanDisk highlighted its IP ownership and control of its entire manufacturing stack (through its JV with Kioxia, now extended through 2034) as a key enabler of its efficient manufacturing capabilities and low capital intensity strategy. Management noted that SanDisk/Kioxia has produced a disproportionate share of industry bit growth relative to CapEx, having produced 29% of the industry's bits in 2021-25 while only comprising 13% of the industry's CapEx. SanDisk noted that the industry spent ~2.7 times more capital per incremental exabyte output than it did in CY25. It expects further die-per-wafer gains, productivity improvements, and more efficient use of tools and cleanroom capacity to support mid-teens bit growth while maintaining capital intensity in the mid-single digits as a percentage of revenue.
- **Strong core NAND roadmap; HBF and KV Cache provide upside optionality.** The SanDisk/Kioxia BiCS roadmap remains the core scaling engine for NAND (with BiCS 9 and BiCS 10 being the latest-generation technology, and BiCS 11-13 already in various stages of development). SanDisk sees its HBF (High Bandwidth Flash) technology as well positioned for AI inference, where longer context and reasoning chains in agentic AI workloads dramatically increase memory bandwidth requirements. Management characterized KV Cache as working memory which is critical during inference in the decode phase, and expects KV Cache to account for ~35% of the 1.2 ZB AI datacenter TAM by 2032. SanDisk sees HBF as key to addressing the "memory wall" in AI by delivering HBM-level read bandwidth with 8X-16X the capacity. In its own simulations, SanDisk noted that HBF-only architectures delivered the same token output with just one half the GPU capacity of HBM-only architectures, which it believes demonstrates the higher GPU and CapEx efficiency of HBF. Management noted that the first HBF memory product has taped out, with first samples expected in CY27.

Price target: Our 12-month target price of \$2,200 is based on a 20X P/E multiple applied to our normalized EPS estimate of \$110. Key downside risks include: (1) Long-term structural change in NAND pricing fails to materialize; (2) YMTC continues to iterate on its roadmap; (3) SanDisk fails to gain eSSD traction.

SNDK	12m Price Target: \$2,200.00	Price: \$1,344.29	Upside: 63.7%
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Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$200.3bn Enterprise value: \$161.1bn 3m ADTV: \$21.2bn United States Americas Semiconductors & IT Services M&A Rank: 3	Revenue (\$ mn)	6/25	6/26	6/27E	6/28E
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	7,355.0	20,248.0	53,154.3	71,041.1
	EBIT (\$ mn)	845.0	12,939.0	43,131.0	54,402.9
	EPS (\$)	689.0	12,700.0	42,883.0	54,122.9
	P/E (X)	2.99	70.16	231.84	284.98
	EV/EBITDA (X)	14.1	7.9	5.8	4.7
	FCF yield (%)	7.7	6.3	4.0	2.5
	Dividend yield (%)	(2.0)	13.4	16.2	19.5
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
		0.4	(0.4)	(0.9)	(1.5)
	EPS (\$)	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		39.25	49.80	59.71	59.05

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 12 Aug 2026 close.

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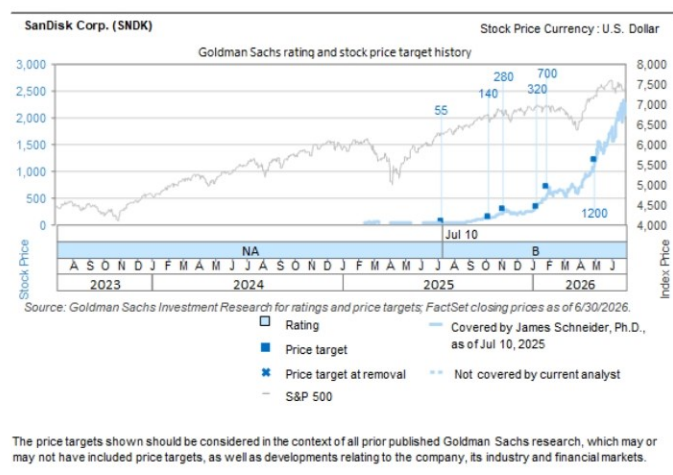
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

SanDisk Corp. (SNDK)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
05-Jul-26	2,200.00	1,745.00
01-May-26	1,200.00	1,187.00
30-Jan-26	700.00	576.25
09-Jan-26	320.00	377.41
07-Nov-25	280.00	239.48
08-Oct-25	140.00	131.88
10-Jul-25	55.00	46.95

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